



FRANCE & THE LOW COUNTRIES



The Netherlands, Belgium, and Luxembourg are sometimes called the Low Countries, because much of the land is flat and low-lying. France and the Low Countries are powerful farming and trading nations, thanks to their good soil and large natural harbors. The people of the region are fond of good food. French chefs are world-famous for their fine cooking skills.



European dream

Many European countries are working together by being members of the European Union. The parliament is at Brussels, in Belgium, and also at Strasbourg, in France.

Chocolate secrets

Many Belgian chocolate makers keep their recipes secret, so no one can copy them.



Brandy



Mint



Coffee



Nougat



Mixed nuts



City canals

Amsterdam is the capital of the Netherlands. It is built around a network of canals that were once used for trade and transportation. By tradition, many Dutch find their way around the city on bicycles.

This stylish outfit is by Christian Lacroix, a top French fashion designer.

Style capital

Paris, the capital of France, is at the heart of the world fashion industry. Every season, famous designers display new creations at big shows.



At war with the sea

Nearly half of the Netherlands was once under seawater. Over the centuries, the Dutch have reclaimed this land from the sea, draining it by using a clever system of canals and sea walls, or dykes. Much of the reclaimed land is now used for intensive crop and dairy farming.

